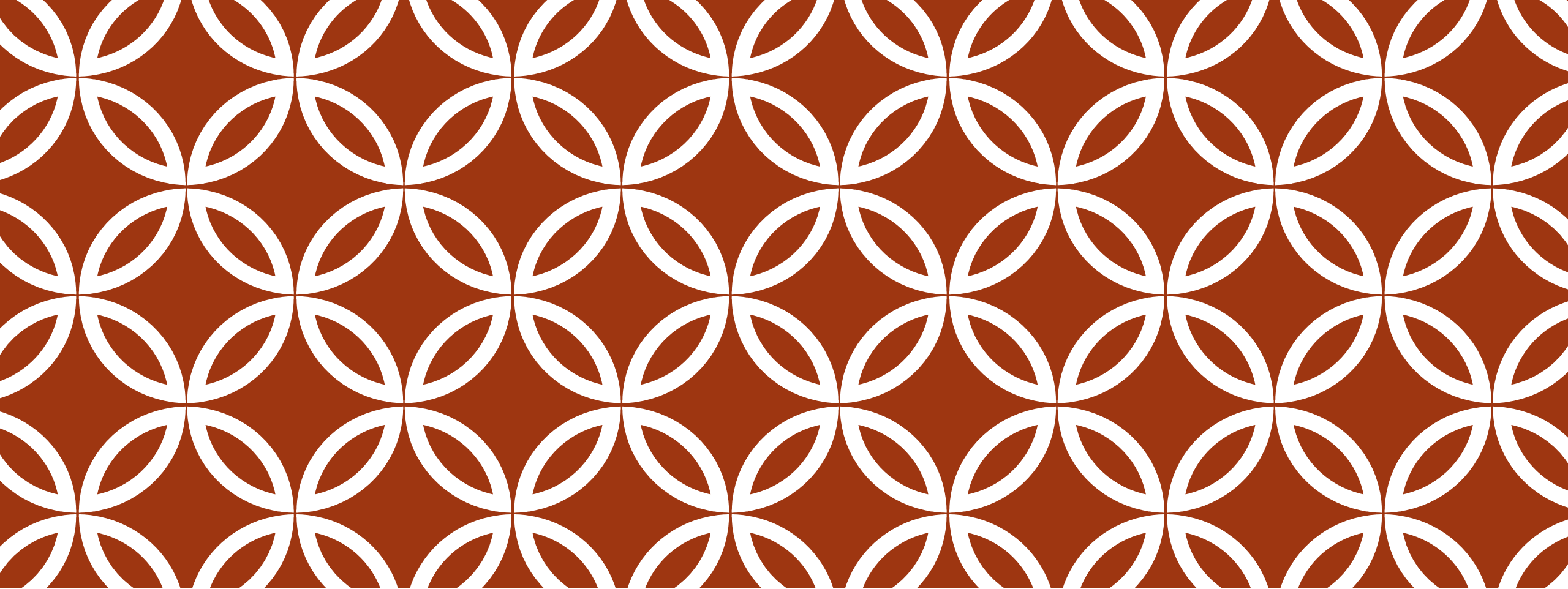




INTRODUCTION TO PSYCHOLOGY (WEEK 1)

BY: AQSA FAYYAZ

Lecturer

(Science and Humanities)

FAST - National University of
Computer & Emerging Sciences

LEARNING OUTCOMES

Understanding the meaning of Psychology

Psychology as a science

Scope of psychology in everyday life

Goals of Psychology

Key debates in Psychology

Branches of Psychology



WHAT IS PSYCHOLOGY?



- Psychology is the **scientific** study of **behavior** and **mental processes**.

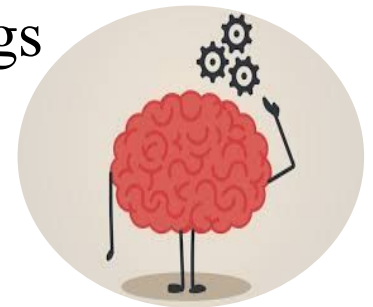
- Behavior: Outward or overt actions and reactions (observable)

Example: running, smiling, dancing, talking



- Mental Processes: all internal, covert activity of mind (hidden)

Example: thoughts, dreaming, sensations, feelings



CONT....

- The word "psychology" comes from the Greek word psyche meaning "breath, spirit, soul", and the Greek word logos meaning the study of something. Thus we can conclude that psychology is the study of soul.
- Psychology is an offspring of subject **philosophy**



PSYCHOLOGY AS A SCIENCE

- Based on scientific principles that emphasizes empiricism, or knowledge based on observation
- Systematic collection and examination of data (empirical evidence) to support or disprove hypotheses (predictions) rather than depending on common sense.

“Psychology is the **scientific** study of **behavior** and **mental processes**.”



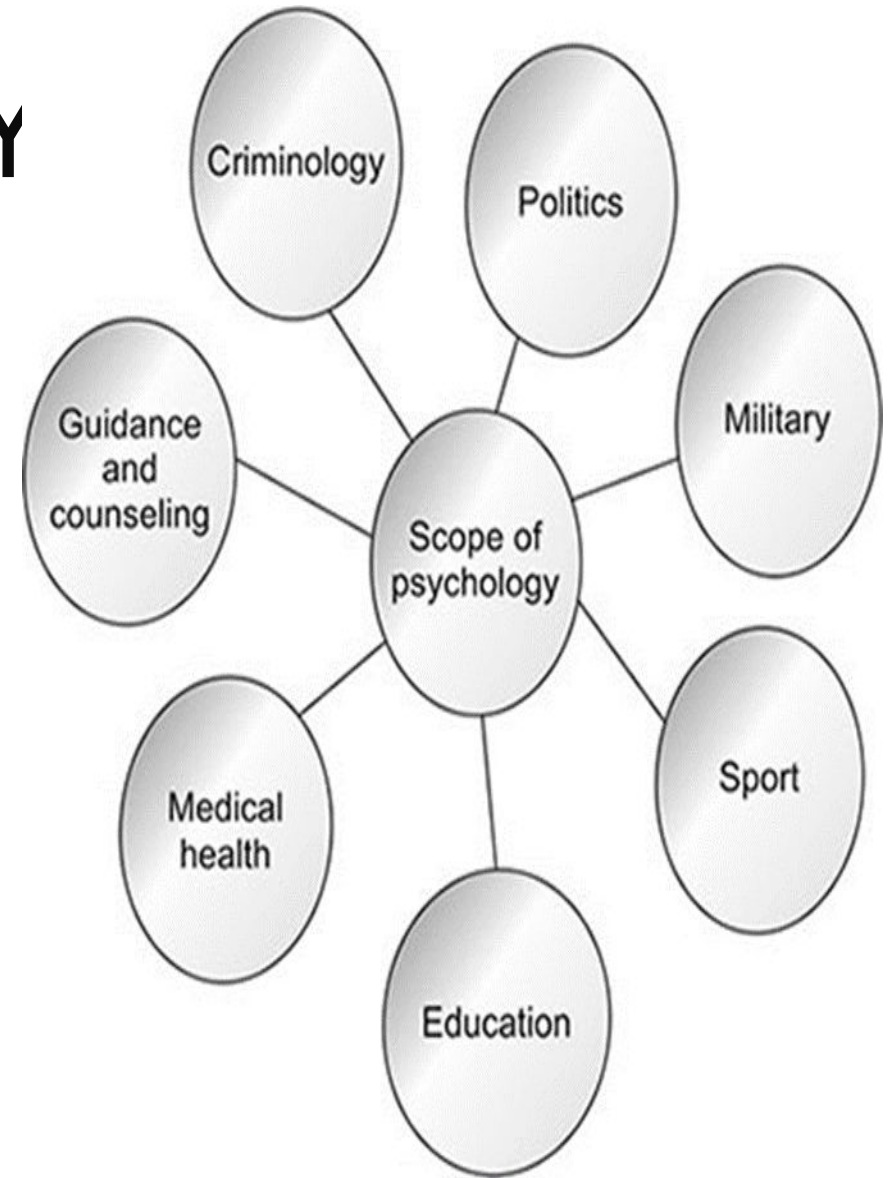
SCOPE OF PSYCHOLOGY

- Psychology today covers enormous range of scope or fields.
- **Basic Research:** Purely theoretical, with the intent of increasing our understanding of certain phenomena.

Theoretical and exploratory; seeks to answer "why" or "how" something works.

- **Applied Research:** methods and findings of scientific psychology to solve practical problems of human and animal behavior and experience.

Solution-oriented; seeks to answer "how to" solve real-world issues.



Basic Research:

1. Examining the cognitive processes involved in decision-making to develop theories about human thought and behavior.
2. Analyzing the formation and evolution of galaxies to understand the universe's structure and history.

Applied research:

1. Implementing new teaching methods derived from cognitive psychology research to improve student learning outcomes.
2. Many psychological studies on addiction reveal that the main cause of addiction is the stress factor.

THINK????

- How is psychology important in your field?

OR

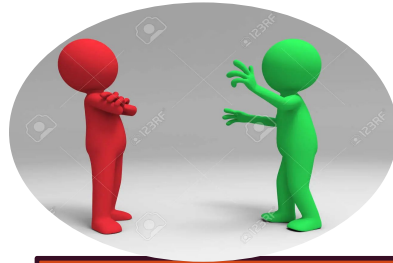
- What makes psychology important in your field?

GOALS OF PSYCHOLOGY



TO DESCRIBE
(**What** is Happening?)

- Observing a behavior and taking note of everything that is happening.



TO EXPLAIN
(**Why** is it happening?)

- Behavior is being understood by explaining it.



TO PREDICT
(**Will** it happen again?)

- Determining what will happen in the future



TO CONTROL
(**How** can it be changed?)

- To change a behavior from an undesirable one to a desirable one.

CONT....

- To describe what is an organism doing?

Documenting the symptoms and behaviors associated with anxiety disorders.

- To explain and understand why organism behave in certain ways?

Investigating how genetic, environmental, and cognitive factors contribute to the development of depression.

- To predict how organism will behave in the future?

Predicting how a person with high stress levels might react to future stressors based on past behaviors and coping mechanisms.

- To control behavior or to modify the particular behavior?

Designing and applying therapeutic techniques to help individuals manage anxiety or developing educational programs to enhance learning and memory.

KEY DEBATES IN PSYCHOLOGY

1. Nature vs. Nurture
 2. Conscious vs. Unconscious Mind
 3. Observable behavior vs. internal mental Processes
 4. Free will vs. determinism
 5. Individual Differences vs. universal Principles
- ❖ These key debates are used to understand how culture, ethnicity, and race influence behavior.

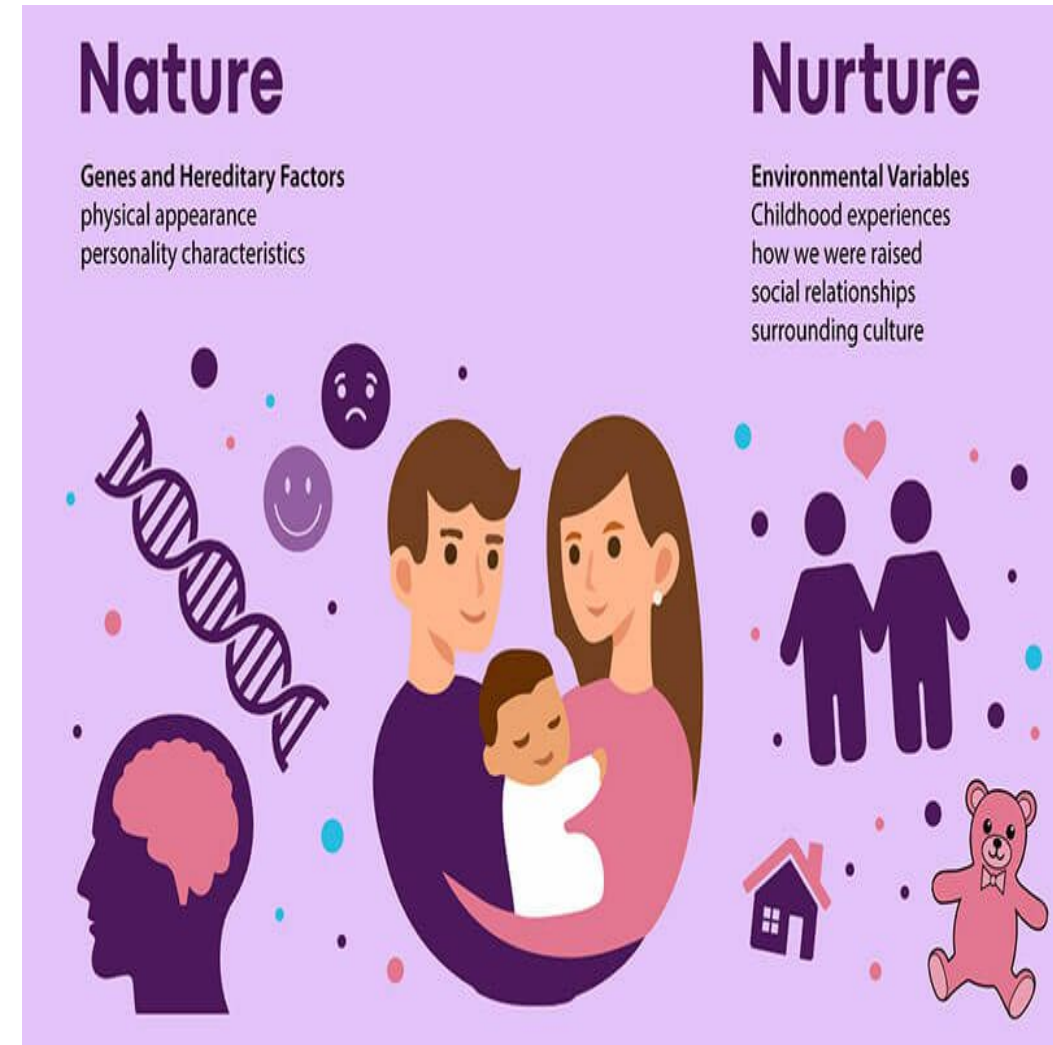
1. NATURE VS NURTURE

- Heredity vs environment
- ❖ How much people's behavior is due to their genetically determined nature

VS

- ❖ How much is due to the influences of the physical and social environment in which a child is raised

E.g.: Intelligence, Personality Traits, Mental Health Disorders, Language Acquisition, Aggression



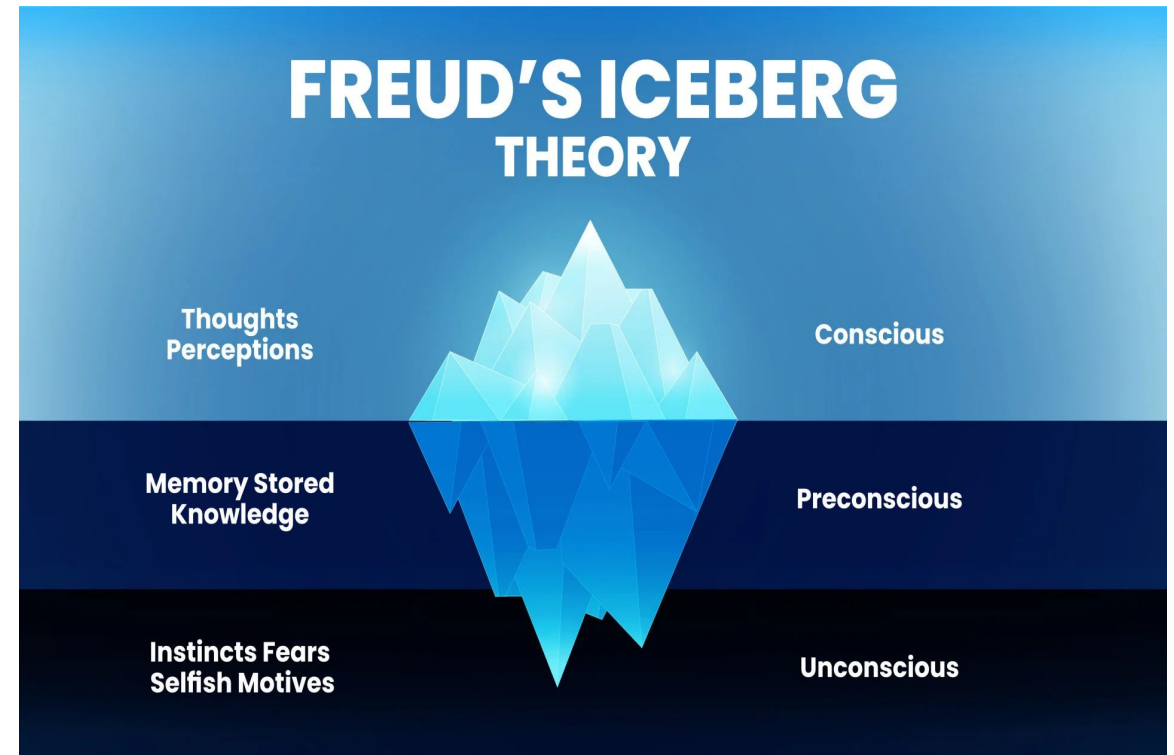
2. CONSCIOUS VS. UNCONSCIOUS MIND

How much of our behavior is produced by forces of which we are fully aware

and

How much is due to unconscious activity
— mental processes that are not accessible to the conscious mind

E.g.: Decision-Making, Emotional Responses, Habit Formation, Freudian Slip



3. OBSERVABLE BEHAVIOR VS. INTERNAL MENTAL PROCESSES

- Psychology should solely be concentrating on behavior that can be seen by outside observers
- Behavioral psychologists think that the only source of information is behavior that can be observed directly

OR

Psychology should focus on unseen thinking processes because according to cognitive psychologist what goes on inside a person's mind is critical to understanding behavior.

E.g.: Learning, Emotional Reactions, Decision-Making, Motivation, Stress Response



4. FREE WILL (CHOICES) VS. DETERMINISM

- How much of our behavior is due to choices made freely by an individual?
- We are free to choose our actions

OR

- How much is produced by factors beyond that individual's voluntary control?
- The assumption that everything that happens has a cause or determinant in the observable world.
- Example: child born in a poor family, will live a poor life.
- GENETIC AND ENVIRONMENT



E.g.: Criminal Behavior, Academic Achievement, Addiction, Personal Relationships, Career Choices



5. INDIVIDUAL DIFFERENCES VS. UNIVERSAL PRINCIPLES

- Focus on the uniqueness of every individual.
- Every person's behavior is a reflection of their distinct and special individual qualities.

OR

- Based on cultural and societal norms and values.



E.g.: Personality Traits, Cognitive Development, Emotional Expression, Learning Styles, Social Norms and Behavior



BRANCHES OF PSYCHOLOGY

- Clinical psychology
- Counselling
- Developmental psychology
- Social psychology
- School and Educational psychology
- Industrial and Organizational psychology
- Sports psychology
- Forensic psychology
- Health psychology

The 5 Pillars of Psychology

BIOLOGICAL

Biopsychology
/Neuroscience

Sensation

Consciousness

COGNITIVE

Perception

Thinking

Intelligence

Memory

DEVELOPMENTAL

Learning

Lifespan
Development

SOCIAL & PERSONALITY

Social

Personality

Emotion

Motivation

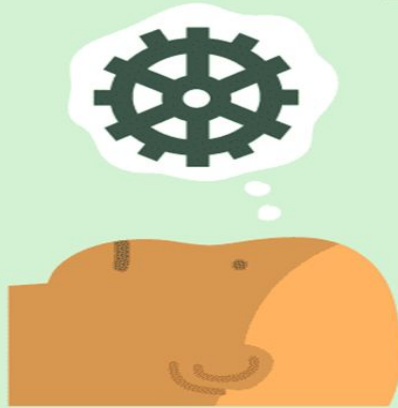
MENTAL & PHYSICAL HEALTH

Abnormal

Therapies

Stress,
Lifestyle, and
Health

Different Schools of Psychology



Cognitive Psychology:
studies mental processes



Humanistic Psychology:
focuses on individual free will



Psychoanalysis:
studies the unconscious mind

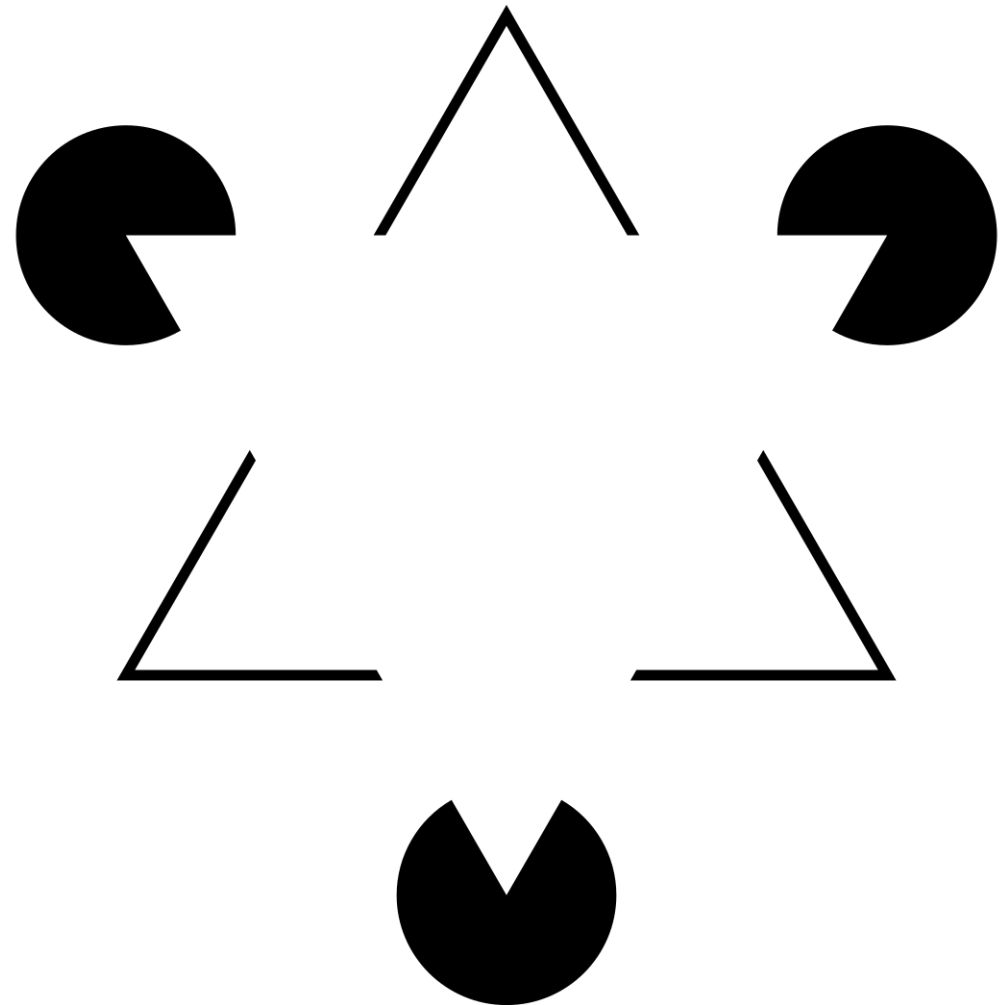
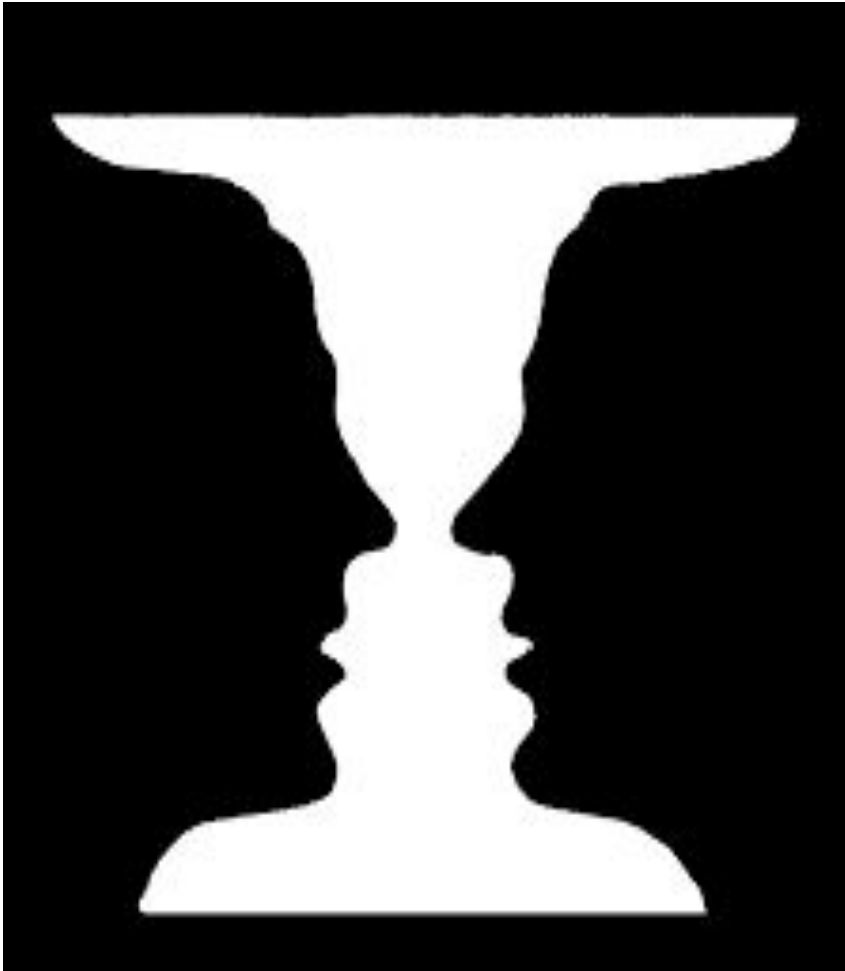


Behaviorism:
focuses on observable behavior



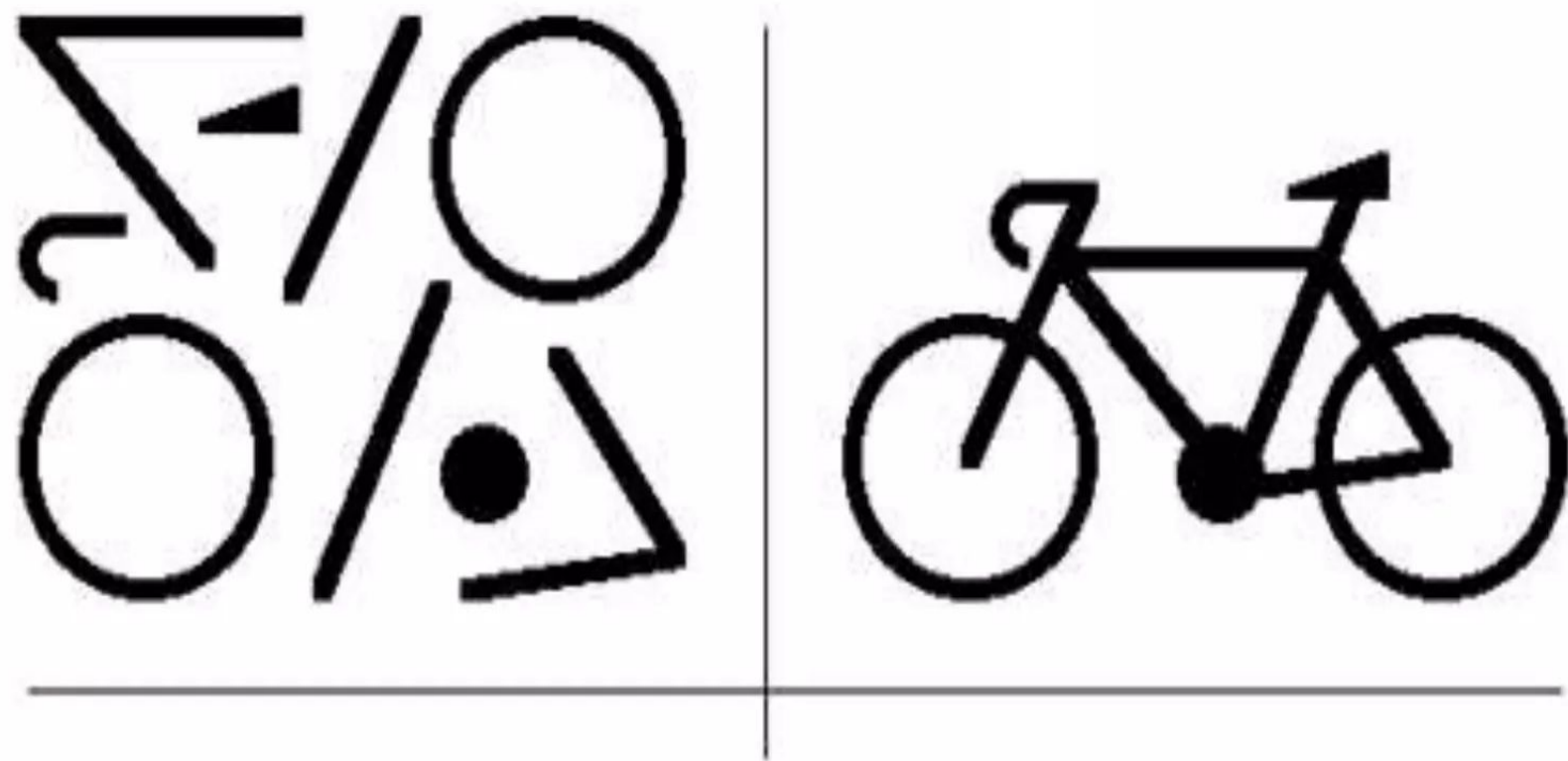
Gestalt Psychology:
studies the mind and behavior
as a whole

GESTALT PSYCHOLOGY



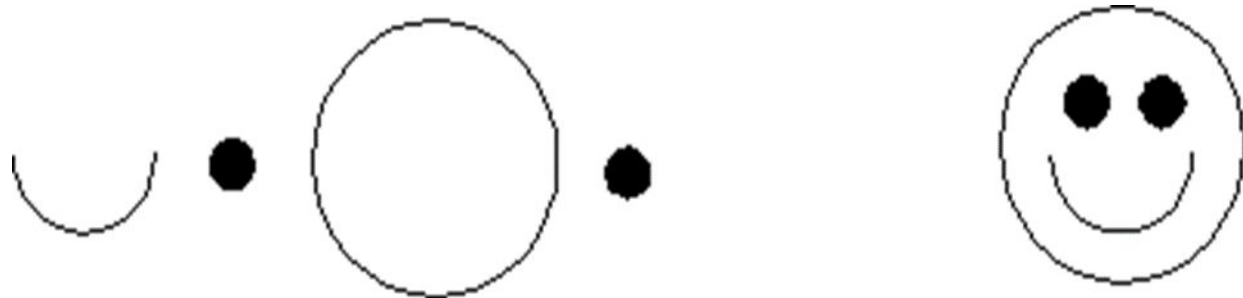


The unified whole is different from the sum of the parts.





- Max Wertheimer (1880–1943), Kurt Koffka (1886–1941), and Wolfgang Köhler (1887–1967) founded Gestalt psychology in the early 20th century.
- The whole is different from the sum of its parts.
- Our perception or understanding of objects is greater and more meaningful than the individuals elements that make up our perceptions.



- 
- When trying to make sense of the world around us, Gestalt psychology suggests that we do not simply focus on every small component. Instead, our minds tend to perceive objects as part of a greater whole and as elements of more complex systems.
 - This school of psychology played a major role in the modern development of the study of human sensation and perception.

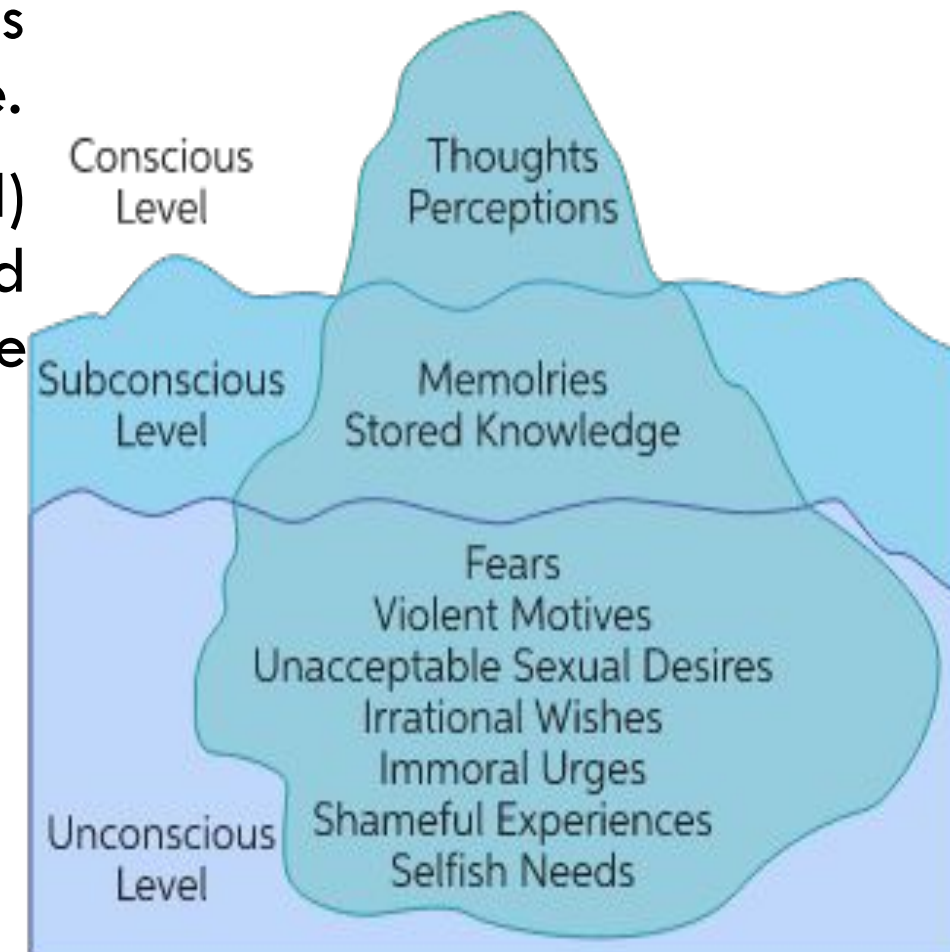
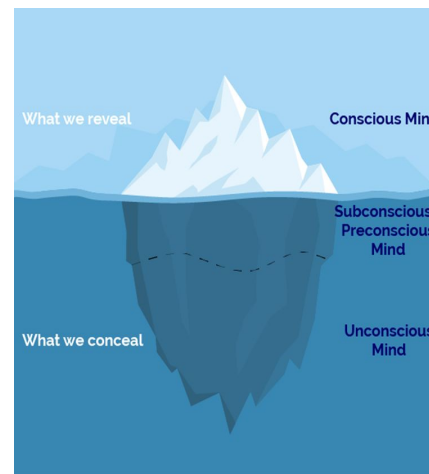
SIGMUND FREUD (1856-1939)



- Austrian physician who founded the psychoanalytic approach to psychology.
- Freud developed a theory based on the existence of the unconscious.
- According to him emotional and behavioral disturbances were based on personal conflicts on an unconscious level.

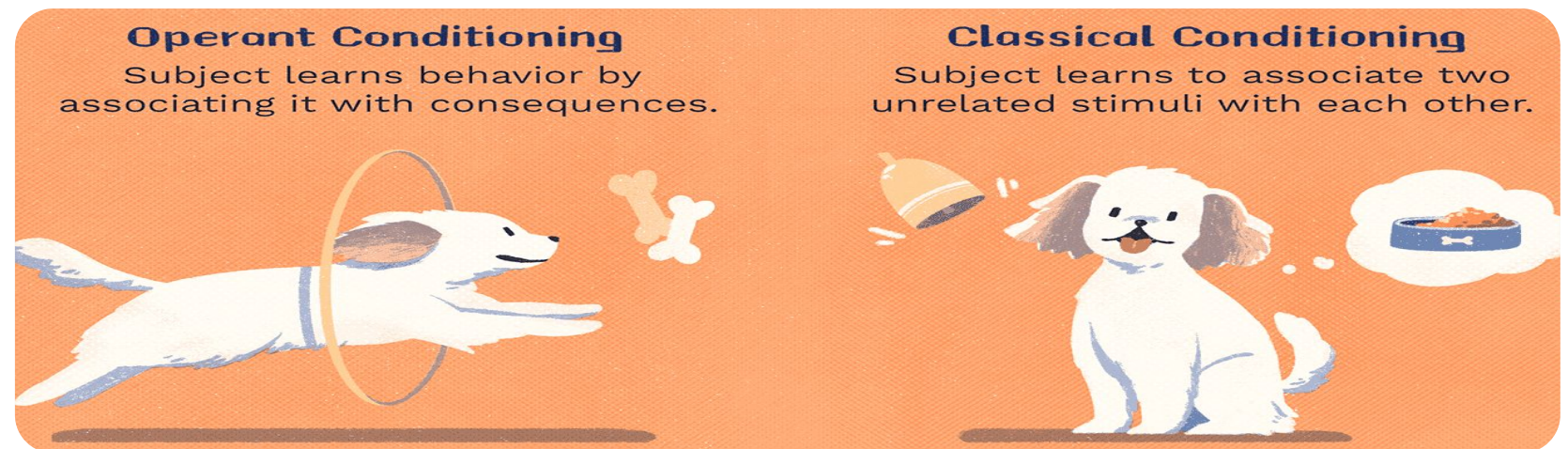


- At the center of Freud's theory is the concept of the unconscious – the thoughts, attitudes, impulses, wishes, motivations, and emotions of which we are unaware.
- Childhood's unacceptable (forbidden or punished) wishes are driven out of conscious awareness and become part of the unconscious, where they continue to influence our thoughts, feelings, and actions.
- **Unconscious thoughts are expressed in dreams, slips of the tongue, and physical mannerisms.**



BEHAVIORISM

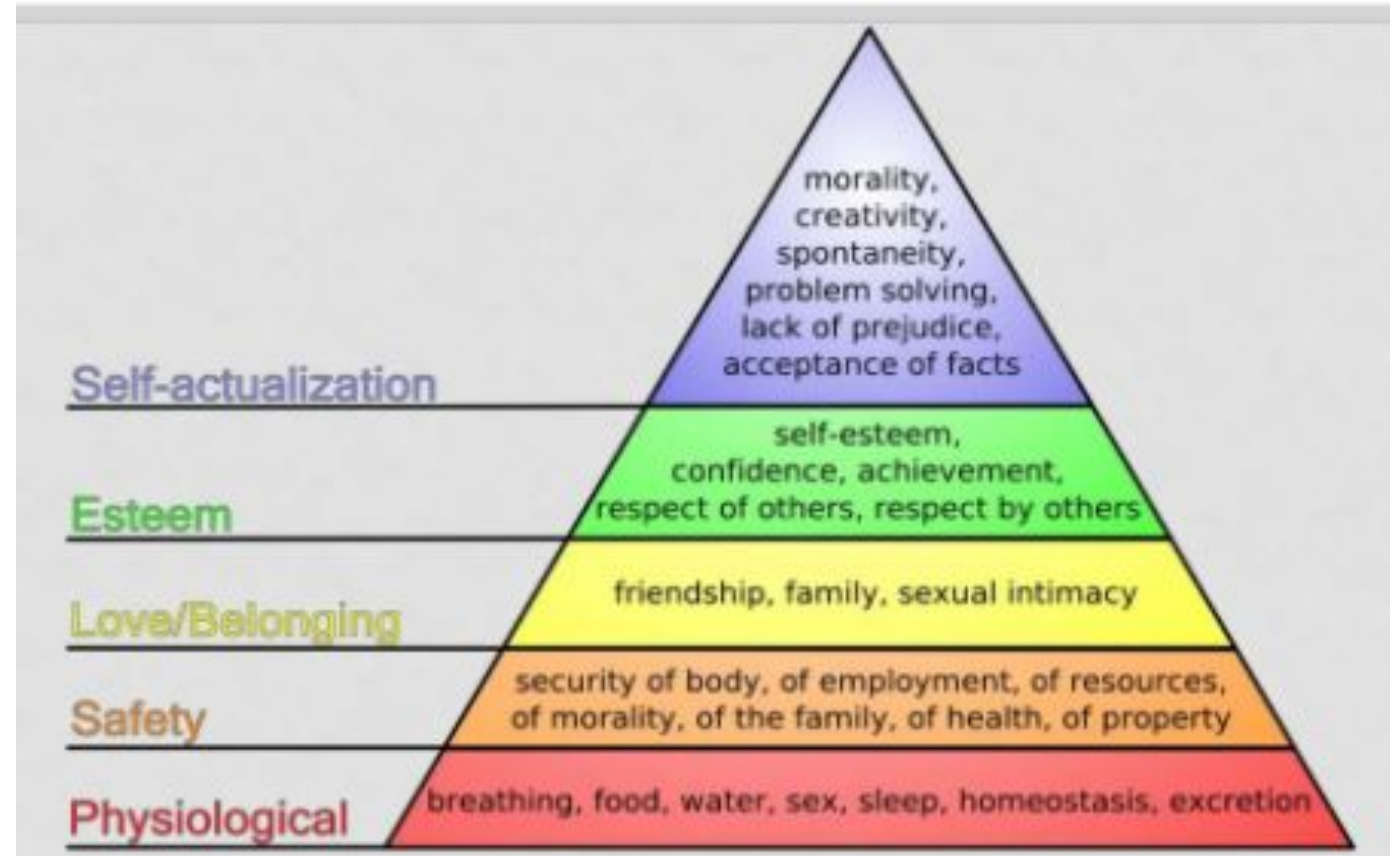
- **John B. Watson**, in 1913 and others ascribing to behaviorism, argued that nearly all behavior is a result of conditioning and the environment shapes behavior by reinforcing specific habits.
- It stated that scientists should only study observable behavior and that consciousness should be abandoned because ultimately consciousness and perceptions are private events and cannot be objectively verified.
- This means that psychology would suffer from a lack of reliability.
- Top names:
 - B.F Skinner
 - Ivan Pavlov



HUMANISTIC PERSPECTIVE

- Humans are capable of incredible acts of creativity, selflessness & high levels of spirituality.
- Free will
- Main figures:
- Carl Rogers , Abraham Maslow

THE HIERARCHY OF NEEDS



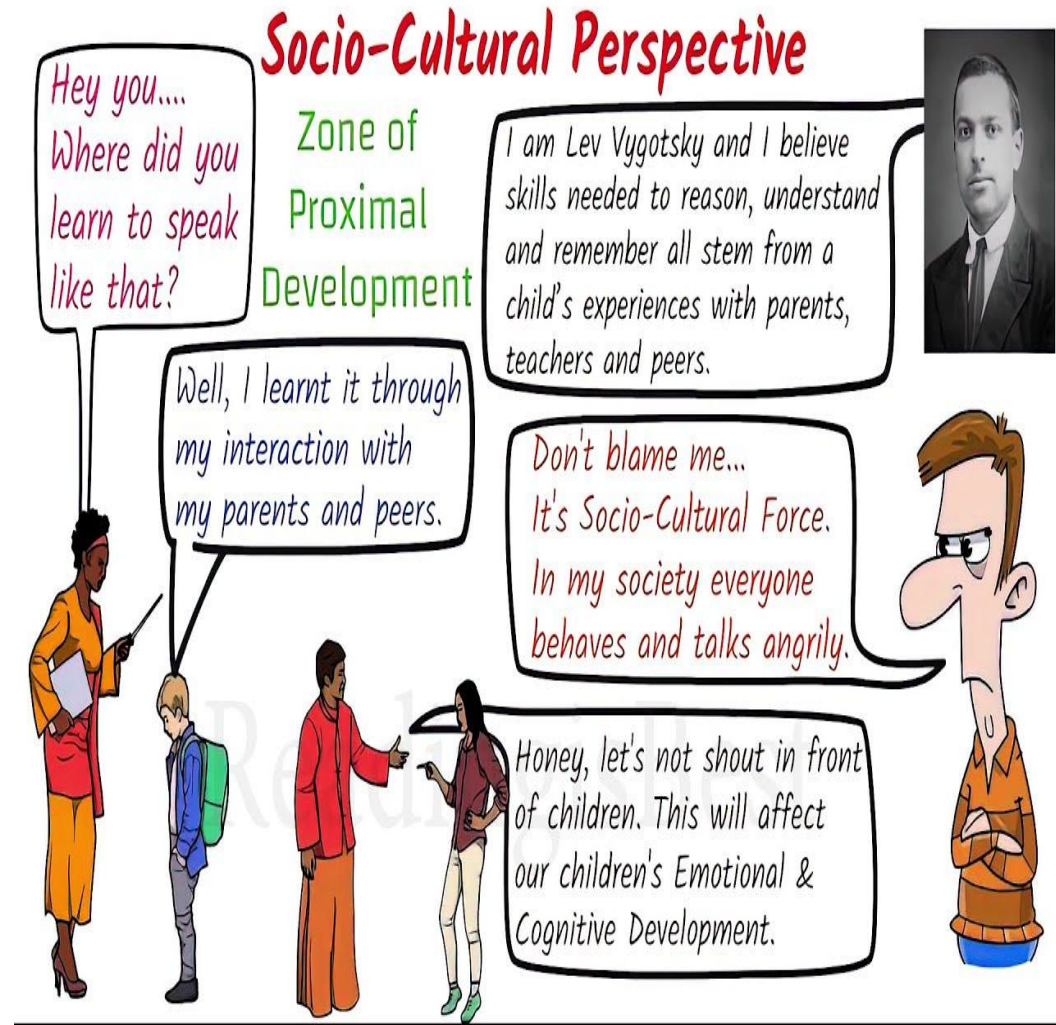
COGNITIVE PERSPECTIVE

- Focus on Mental processes
- Perceiving, remembering, reasoning, deciding, and problem solving
- Only by studying mental processes can we fully understand what organisms do.



SOCIO-CULTURAL PERSPECTIVE

- Sociocultural theory is an emerging theory in Psychology that looks at the important contributions that society makes to individual development.
- Sociocultural theory focuses not only how adults and peers influence individual learning, but also on how and attitudes affect how learning takes place.
cultural beliefs



- This theory stresses the interaction between developing people and the culture in which they live.
- Sociocultural theory also suggests that human learning is largely a social process.

EXAMPLES

- Investigating how cultural factors influence psychological phenomena, such as emotional expression, cognitive processes, and social behaviors.
- Studying how individuals adapt to new cultural environments and the impact of this process on their psychological well-being.

ECLECTIC APPROACH



- Multi-modal or integrative therapy
- Integration of Theories and Techniques
- Flexibility in Methods
- Customization to Client Needs
- Selecting and adopting information from many different sources rather than relying on one perspective.



THANK YOU